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May 7, 1980
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. AA-E-35C
October 26, 1978

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

EASEL, DISPLAY AND TRAINING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a folding easel which can function as a chalkboard, display board, or be used for visual presentation.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Washington, DC; Philadelphia; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Houston; Denver; San Francisco; Los Angeles; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedure and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Metal. Hinges, springs, and braces shall be steel or a suitable metal, and unless of corrosion resistant steel or aluminum alloy, suitable for coating as required by 3.5.

3.1.1.1 Aluminum. The aluminum shall be extruded aluminum alloy seamless tubing of a commercial quality capable of meeting the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Design. The easel shall be designed with a panel having a front working surface of green chalkboard. Provision shall be made for holding paper by means of two posts or other projections. The legs shall be designed to impart strength and rigidity to the easel under normal usage and shall fold compactly for storage and transportation. When the easel is in an opened position, the bracing leg(s) shall swing or pivot out to maintain the easel in an upright position, and shall be held in place by a spring-type release pin and slot, or comparable type positive locking mechanism. The pin or locking mechanism shall be capable of being released without the aid of tools, and shall afford protection against accidental collapse of the easel during use or relocation within a work area. When tested as specified in 4.4 the front legs of the easel shall not lift off the floor. Provisions shall be made for the display of paperboard charts or similar matter at three or more different heights in order to ensure proper visibility. The three heights shall be 24, 27, and 30 inches ± 1 inch measured from bottom of chart to the floor. The chalk trough or shelf may be used for the display of paperboard charts at different heights (see 3.3.3). A handle which shall facilitate carrying of the folded easel shall be securely attached at a suitable location.

3.3 Construction. The easel shall be constructed so that all parts align, where applicable, and shall not work loose in service.

3.3.1 Panel. The panel shall be of tempered hardboard or aluminum at the manufacturer's option. The front chalkboard surface shall be such that chalk will produce distinct and uniform markings which can be erased with one or two strokes of a felt eraser. The dimensions of the working surface of the panel shall be not less than 27-1/2 inches wide by 36 inches high. Hardboard panel edges shall be enclosed in a flange-type aluminum frame. Aluminum panels shall be enclosed in either an extrusion or shall be turned or rounded in such a manner as to impart strength and rigidity. The edges of aluminum panels shall be dulled or beveled in such a manner as to present a smooth surface and permit safe handling.

3.3.1.1 Posts or projections. The top of the working surface of the panel shall have two posts or other projections which shall satisfactorily accommodate paper pads up to 1/2-inch in thickness. The posts or projections shall be not less than 7/32-inch in diameter and located at equal distances from the panel sides. They shall accommodate paper pads having two holes of the following dimensions:

Diameter of holes	5/16 ± 1/16-inch
Distance between holes, center to center	17-1/2 ± 1/16-inch
Distance from center of holes to top of pad	1/2 ± 1/16-inch

An aluminum clamp strip or hinged bar shall firmly hold the paper pads on posts or projections. The strip or bar shall be the full width of the working surface of the panel and shall be provided with a locking device.

3.3.1.2 Storage container. A storage container which shall store 5 x 2 x 1-1/4 inch felt eraser along with several crayons, felt tip markers, and pieces of chalk shall be either permanently attached to the back of the panel or an integral part of the chalk trough or shelf (see 3.3.3).

3.3.2 Leg assembly. The easel shall be of either three-leg or four-leg construction at the manufacturer's option provided that necessary support is assured for maximum stability. Each leg shall be made of aluminum tubing (see 3.1.1.1) with a wall thickness of not less than .049-inch. The hinges, braces, and springs, if used, shall be metal and shall be riveted, welded, or otherwise secured in such a manner as to permit the legs to fold into the back of the panel and to facilitate assembly of the easel. A clip or similar device shall hold the folded legs in place. The bottom of each leg shall be designed to protect floors and prevent the easel from moving when in use. The easel shall not move more than three inches from its original position when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.3.3 Chalk trough or shelf. There shall be a removable front mounted trough or shelf for holding writing instruments, which may double as the support for display of paperboard charts or similar matter. The trough or shelf shall be not less than 18 inches long, 2-1/2 inches wide, 1 inch deep, and shall be made from material of sufficient thickness to firmly support the chalk, eraser, crayons, and when applicable, paperboard or other matter. It shall be readily removable and provisions may be made for the purpose of displaying charts or similar matter, the trough or shelf shall be adjustable at three or more different levels. The trough or shelf shall be so constructed that it will correctly align and securely fasten at each of the levels. The chalk trough or shelf may have an integral drawer for storage or eraser, crayons, and chalk (see 3.3.1.2).

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3.4 Dimensions. The easel shall measure no less than 70 inches in height when in an upright or unfolded position. When folded for handling and storage, the dimensions of the easel shall be as shown in table I.

TABLE I. Dimensions of the folded easel

Inches	Depth	Width	Height
Maximum	2	29	40

3.5 Finish. All aluminum parts shall be anodized or have a baked-on hammertone, or a polished finish which shall protect the aluminum from corrosion. The hinges, braces and springs, if used, shall have a baked enamel finish or an equivalent protective coating which shall produce a uniform surface without runs, grit, areas of thin film, or chips.

3.6 Operating instructions. Operating instructions for the opening and folding of the easel shall be attached to the back of the panel.

3.7 Identification marking. Each easel shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

3.8 Workmanship. Rivets, if used, shall be neatly and firmly set. All other fasteners shall be firmly tightened. The easel shall be free from burrs, rough or sharp edges, or other defects or imperfections which will impair serviceability and adversely effect appearance or which might constitute a personal hazard to the user.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection. A random sample of easels shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) Of 4.0 percent. The sample unit shall be one easel.

4.2.2 Sampling for preparation for deliver. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL Of 4.0 percent.

4.2.3 Sampling for operational test. A random sample of easels shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3 with an AQL Of 4.0 percent. The sample unit shall be one easel.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.1 shall be examined to determine that the easels conform to the requirements of section 3 of this specification.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL Of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective.

4.4 Operation test. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be subjected to the following test. Assemble the easel in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions and place it on a linoleum floor. Using white marking chalk, write the preceding sentence in letters 2 inches high. The writing shall be clearly visible from twenty feet away. Erase the writing with a clean, felt eraser. Evaluate the easel for compliance with 3.2. 3.3.1 and 3.3.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A and B. Each easel, folded to minimum cubeage, shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, style optional. The easel shall be braced and cushioned to prevent damage during multiple shipments, handling and storage. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Commercial. Each easel shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete package shall be designed to protect the item against damage during shipment, handling and storage.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

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5.2.1 Level A. Easels of like description packaged as specified in 5.1.1 in quantities specified (see 6.2), shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, grades V3c, V2s or V3s, style optional. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Easels of like description packaged as specified in 5.1.1 in quantities specified (see 6.2) shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except that the boxes shall conform to class domestic and the waterproof sealing shall not be required.

5.2.3 Commercial. Easels of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in fiberboard boxes to assure delivery at destination, to provide for redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and shall be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification and Uniform Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

5.3.2 Military activities. Interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Easels covered by this specification are intended for use in paper pad and flip chart presentation, chalk talks and for paperboard chart and poster display purposes.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Packaging, packing, and marking required.

6.3 Recovered materials. Recovered materials shall be used to the maximum extent practicable.

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein.

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